CLASSICAL BEAUTY Tara (left) and Hanuman (below)—two bronze figurines from the Bhedwar collection



war's love for these unique pieces. Curated inhouse by the directors of the gallery, the show, titled *Building the Past: An Architect Collector,* takes a closer look at a fraction of the collection of what Khandalavala famously cited as among "the best private collection of metal images in the country. It is a collection built up over 30 years with great discrimination..." Among the displays are two of the best-known Nepalese bronzes—the 'Tara' and the 'Bodhisattva'.

It has been 70 years since Bhedwar's death, and it's the first time since then that a part of his collection is being displayed. "The central concern of the exhibition is to do with connoisseurship. As a producer of culture, Bhedwar was creating a new, future-looking Bombay through the buildings he was designing," says a gallery spokesperson. "His deep interest in classical Indian art reveals an interest in a long art historical trajectory. This coming together of the past, the present and the future was a feature of connoisseurship during the first half of the 20th century."

The exhibition is also an attempt to draw one's focus to why Bhedwar deserves recognition as both an architect and a connoisseur of classical Indian art. According to the gallery, "This exhibition acknowledges his importance to both communities." His extensive investment in sculptures and miniatures was an endeavour three decades in the making. Each piece shows Bhedwar's sensitive eye that didn't miss a detail in the intricacies of form, balance and iconography. While his architectural design was anchored in structural astuteness and functionality, his collection is a testament to his dedication to spiritual and artistic heritage. Whether it's the tranquility of a standing Buddha from the Kathmandu Valley or a Hindu deity in motion, these collectables traverse an astonishing range. "The gallery has always taken the view that contemporary art does not emerge out of a vacuum and that it is important for us to present work that is able to provide context for the art that is being made at present," says the gallery, underlining the significance of leaning into the past for a better reading of the present and the future. ■

BHEDWAR **was a scholar and collector of art, especially Nepali and south Indian bronzes**

—Arshia

▼ **KOLKATA**

BUILDING BRIDGES



On view at **Emami Art** *till August 9*

The octogenarian Partha Pratim Deb is showing works done over the past two decades in an exhibition titled *Play-Forms*. Deb trained at Santiniketan and at MS University, Baroda, and his works marry Santiniketan's philosophical approach with the progressive experimentalism of Baroda. Here, vibrant paintings, expressive drawings and playful objects that blur the line between toy and sculpture show his astonishing range.



On view at **Experimenter Colaba** *till August 20*

▼ **MUMBAI**

Weft and Warp

In *Volume IV: Truths, Half-Truths, Half-Lies, Lies,* which opens on July 10, Kallol Datta uses textile as a lens to examine the intersection of gender politics, hierarchies, censorship and other issues. The exhibition features experimental work stemming from Datta's research into imperial laws and religious edicts of the past.

—Compiled by Amit Dixit